Lesson plan · for the teacher

A one-page cyber safety policy

Cyber security · Level 4 · Lesson 1

Time
40 min

Materials
One sheet of A4 paper and a pen per group; The five headings on the board: Who leads, Accounts, Devices, Data and groups, Incidents; The school's old policy or rules, if there are any

Learning goals

- Draft a one-page policy covering roles, accounts, devices, data, groups and incidents.
- Write password rules that follow current guidance.
- Plan how staff, pupils and parents will agree to it.

Activity: Policy workshop: one page in 40 minutes

1. Warm-up (5 min): Each person writes, on a slip of paper, the one rule they would put first in a school cyber policy. Read a few aloud without names.
2. Sort (8 min): Together, place every slip under one of the five headings on the board: Who leads, Accounts, Devices, Data and groups, Incidents. Notice which headings are empty.
3. Draft (15 min): Split into five small groups, one heading each. Each group writes two or three rules in plain words, with the name of the person responsible. Password rules follow current guidance: long passphrases, no forced monthly changes, two-step sign-in.
4. Read-aloud test (8 min): One person reads the whole page aloud. Everyone marks any rule that is impossible for them, unclear, or costs money the school doesn't have. Rewrite those on the spot.
5. Wrap-up (4 min): Agree who will tidy the draft onto one page, the date everyone signs it, and where it will hang. Note the date of the first review.

Run this in a staff meeting. Write the five headings on the board before people arrive, bring the school's old rules if there are any, and invite the bursar or office staff: they hold the most data.

Discussion

- Which rule in our current practice does nobody follow, and why?
- Who should be our cyber lead, and who the deputy?
- What will we tell parents, in one sentence?

Exit ticket

- One rule I will write in plain words for our policy.

Try it at school tomorrow
Ask three colleagues, one of them from the school office, which single rule they would put first in a school cyber safety policy. Write their answers on one sheet: it is the first draft of your page.

Practice questions · for you

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1 **A colleague says: "The longer our policy, the safer we are." What is the best reply?**

- ◯ It doesn't matter, as long as the head teacher has signed it
- ◯ Agree: more rules cover more risks
- ◯ Disagree: people follow what they can read, so one clear page protects more

2 **Which rules belong in a modern school password policy? Choose all that apply.**

- ☐ At least 15 characters, or at least 8 with two-step sign-in
- ☐ Every password must contain a symbol and a number
- ☐ Everyone changes their password every 30 days
- ☐ Change a password when there are signs it leaked
- ☐ Block common and leaked passwords

3 **Match each rule to its heading on the page.**

Two-step sign-in on staff email	• • • •	Devices
A screen lock and automatic updates	• • • •	Incidents
Two admins for every official group	• • • •	Accounts
Report a mistake the same day, without blame	• • • •	Data and groups

4 **If the cyber lead writes the policy alone and the head teacher signs it, staff will follow it just as well as one they helped write.**

- ◯ True
- ◯ False

5 **Put the steps for making the policy stick in order.**

- ☐ Read it aloud at a staff meeting and ask what is impossible
- ☐ Draft it with three or four colleagues, the bursar included
- ☐ Everyone signs it, and it goes on the staffroom wall
- ☐ Review it after a year, or after an incident
- ☐ Fix the rules people can't keep

✎ **Which habit at your school would surprise a parent most if they knew about it? Which line of your one-page policy would change it?**

Check your answers

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1 **Disagree: people follow what they can read, so one clear page protects more**

A rule protects only when people know it and act on it.

2 **At least 15 characters, or at least 8 with two-step sign-in; Change a password when there are signs it leaked; Block common and leaked passwords**

Length, change on evidence of a leak, and a block on common and leaked passwords are today's guidance (NIST, 2025).

3 **Two-step sign-in on staff email — Accounts**
A screen lock and automatic updates — Devices
Two admins for every official group — Data and groups
Report a mistake the same day, without blame — Incidents

Five headings keep the page short and make each rule easy to find.

4 **False**

People follow rules they understand and helped shape.

5 **Top to bottom: 2, 1, 4, 5, 3**

Write with the people who will follow it, test it aloud, fix what can't work, then commit to it.